Tweaking AGENCY

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UTM attribution fix — engineering handoff

Client: **Gimme Care** Date: **2026-06-25** Area: **LP → intake link decoration**

TL;DR for the frontend dev

Google click IDs carry fine (~99%). The five `utm_*` params do not — they are dropped on ~98% of paid sessions between the landing page and intake.

Root cause: the CTA link-decoration script that fills the placeholder slot in the intake URL only injects `gclid`, `gbraid`, and `promo` from the first-party `att_*` cookies. It never injects `utm_*` — even though those values are sitting in cookies (`att_utm_source`, `att_utm_medium`, etc.) at click time.

Fix: add the `att_utm_*` cookie values to the param list the decorator already builds, build the query string with `URLSearchParams` (so empty values are skipped), and apply it to both CTA URL structures. Estimated effort: ~1 hour. **No changes to the intake app and no changes to click-ID / Conversion Linker logic are required.**

The problem (business impact)

When someone clicks a Google ad and lands on a Gimme LP, the URL carries both the Google click ID (`gclid`) and the campaign UTMs (`utm_source`, `utm_medium`, `utm_campaign`, `utm_term`, `utm_content`). When they click a CTA into the intake flow, the `gclid` survives but the UTMs are stripped off the URL.

The consequence: on the intake side we can see *that* a paid click happened, but not *which campaign, ad group, keyword, or creative* drove it. Any UTM-based reporting (PostHog funnels segmented by campaign/term/content, and any downstream analytics) is effectively blind for the vast majority of paid intake sessions. This weakens campaign- and keyword-level CVR/CPA analysis and makes it harder to attribute intake conversions back to spend.

Measured leak (PostHog, last 7 days — paid LP → intake sessions)

LANDING PAGE	SESSIONS	KEPT `GCLID`	KEPT `UTM_SOURCE`
`/lp/tirzepatide`	2,421	99.0%	2.4%
`/lp/shop-glp-1-gip-3-v2`	276	99.3%	1.1%

100% of these LP pageviews had `utm_source` present on the landing page itself, yet ~98% lose it before the intake pageview. The loss is systemic across both LP structures.

How this is happening (technical root cause)

1. Ad click → LP loads with e.g. `?gclid=...&utm_source=google&utm_medium=cpc&utm_campaign=...&utm_term=...&utm_content=...`
2. On load, the site's attribution JS writes first-party cookies on `.gimme.care` : `att_gclid` , `att_gbraid` , `att_utm_source` , `att_utm_medium` , `att_utm_campaign` , `att_utm_term` , `att_utm_content` , `att_promo` , `att_promo-source` . **All of these are confirmed present at click time, including every UTM.**
3. The CTA `<a>` tags are static with an **empty placeholder slot** in the query string:
    - `/lp/shop-glp-1-gip-3-v2` → `get.gimme.care/start-online-visit/wl-rd-tirz?promo=GimmeS20OFF&promo-source=coupon&&` (note the trailing `&&`)
    - `/lp/tirzepatide` → `intake.gimme.care/wl?&` and `intake.gimme.care/?&`
4. On click, the decorator reads the `att_*` cookies and fills the placeholder, then navigates (tirzepatide LP goes direct to intake; shop-glp LP hops through `get.gimme.care` which redirects to `intake.gimme.care`).
5. **The bug:** the decorator only writes `gclid` , `gbraid` , and `promo` / `promo-source` into the slot. It never writes `utm_*` . So intake receives the click IDs but no UTMs.

Root cause

The link-decoration builder injects click IDs + promo but omits all `utm_*` keys

The UTM data is available in the `att_utm_*` cookies the whole time — the builder simply does not include those keys in the query string it constructs for the outbound intake link.

This also explains the `&=&=undefined` URLs

The empty placeholder slots (`&&` / `?&`) are what render as `&=&=undefined` when the builder tries to fill a value that is missing or `undefined` (e.g. cold first click before cookies are written, or non-Google traffic). Building the query string properly (step 3 below) removes this malformed-URL artifact at the same time.

How we proved it

TEST	WHAT WE DID	RESULT
1	Navigated **directly** to an intake URL with UTMs manually in it: `intake.gimme.care/wl/intro?utm_source=google&utm_medium=cpc&...`	Intake **preserved every UTM** (and appended `promo` from cookies). → Intake does **not** strip UTMs.
2	Loaded the LP from a simulated ad click and inspected cookies + CTA href at click time.	`att_utm_source=google` , `att_utm_medium=cpc` , `att_utm_campaign` , `att_utm_term` , `att_utm_content` all present — yet CTA href was still the empty `intake.gimme.care/wl?&` . → Data available, builder ignores it.
3	Manually injected the `att_utm_*` cookie values into the CTA href and clicked through.	Landed on `intake.gimme.care/wl/intro?utm_source=google&utm_medium=cpc&utm_campaign=...&utm_term=...&utm_content=...&gclid=...&gbraid=...` — **all 5 UTMs carried end-to-end.** → Injection works; the only gap is the builder's param list.

The fix — steps for the frontend dev

1

Locate the link-decoration logic

Find the code that fills the placeholder slot (`&&` / `?&`) on CTA click. It is the same script that already reads the `att_*` cookies and injects `gclid` / `gbraid` / `promo` into the outbound link to `get.gimme.care` / `intake.gimme.care` (the site's attribution / param-builder script).

2

Add the UTM keys to the param list it injects

Map each `att_*` cookie to its query param:

```
// add to the existing cookie→param mapping
att_utm_source   → utm_source
att_utm_medium   → utm_medium
att_utm_campaign → utm_campaign
att_utm_term     → utm_term
att_utm_content  → utm_content
// (also forward gad_source if it is being captured)
```

3 Build the query string with `URLSearchParams` and skip empty values

Only append a key when its cookie value is present and non-empty. Never emit empty `utm_source=` or the `&=&` / `=undefined` placeholders. This also fixes the existing malformed-URL artifact.

```
// illustrative — match to your existing builder
function buildIntakeUrl(base) {
  const get = k => { const m = document.cookie.match('(?:^|; )' + k + '=([^;]*)
  const map = {
    utm_source: 'att_utm_source', utm_medium: 'att_utm_medium',
    utm_campaign: 'att_utm_campaign', utm_term: 'att_utm_term',
    utm_content: 'att_utm_content', gclid: 'att_gclid',
    gbraid: 'att_gbraid', promo: 'att_promo', 'promo-source': 'att_promo-source
  };
  const p = new URLSearchParams();
  for (const [param, cookie] of Object.entries(map)) {
    const v = get(cookie);
    if (v) p.set(param, v);   // only set when present → no empty/undefined key
  }
  const qs = p.toString();
  return qs ? base + '?' + qs : base;
}
```

4 Apply to BOTH CTA URL structures and the redirect hop

Use the builder for the direct `intake.gimme.care` links (tirzepatide LP) *and* the `get.gimme.care` links (shop-glp LP). Critically, the `get.gimme.care` → `intake.gimme.care` redirect must **forward the UTMs onward too**, not just `gclid` / `gbraid` — otherwise they are dropped at the hop.

5 Remove the empty placeholder slots from the static hrefs

Once the builder constructs the full query string dynamically, delete the hard-coded empty `&&` / `?&` from the CTA hrefs in Webflow (or wherever the CTAs are authored). Those empty slots are what render as `&=&=undefined` when cookies are missing.

Acceptance criteria (QA before sign-off)

- Load a LP with `?gclid=TEST&utm_source=google&utm_medium=cpc&utm_campaign=foo&utm_term=bar&utm_content=baz`, click **each** CTA, and confirm the final intake URL contains all of: `gclid`, `utm_source`, `utm_medium`, `utm_campaign`, `utm_term`, `utm_content`.
- Confirm **no** `&=&`, no `=undefined`, and no empty `utm_source=` appear in any intake URL.
- Load a LP with **no** UTM params (e.g. direct/organic) and confirm the CTAs do not emit empty UTM keys.
- Verify on both `/lp/tirzepatide` (direct-to-intake) and `/lp/shop-glp-1-gip-3-v2` (via `get.gimme.care`).
- After deploy, re-check PostHog: `utm_source` on intake for Google paid LP→intake sessions should climb from ~2% toward ~99% (matching `gclid`).

What NOT to change (scope guardrails)

- **Do not touch the intake app.** It already preserves whatever query params it is handed — verified directly (Test 1).
- **Do not touch the Conversion Linker / `gclid` handling.** Click-ID carry is already ~99% and working correctly.
- This is purely a change to the **LP / redirect link-decoration param list** — adding the UTM keys the builder already has access to.